

**Realme C17 launch**

Housing a Snapdragon 460 SoC and a 90Hz display, rumours hint towards a December launch. <http://digit.in/nov20-55>

**Micromax teases In-series**

Micromax is returning to the Indian market with the In-series of devices, running on Mediatek SoCs. <http://digit.in/nov20-56>

# Realme 55-inch SLED TV

## Well built TV with good audio



**I**t's always exciting when new technology is unveiled. So, you can imagine our excitement when Realme said they were introducing a new backlighting technology. They call it SLED. So, how does this new backlighting technology affect the content we consume? Read on and find out.



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content, Realme lacks the ability for a user to control picture presets and other settings from the native apps. The same overexposed experience we saw in HDR can also be experienced in SDR. In Mission: Impossible Rogue Nation, the sky and sunlight in the background looked overexposed.

Switching to the Movie preset when consuming content from the Fire TV stick helped with this. Overall, one can get decent picture performance from the TV but when using an external device, since it lets you control the picture settings. Surprisingly, the gaming performance wasn't affected by the overexposure issue we faced when consuming content.

**Audio**

The Realme SLED TV has 24W of sound output. The sound from the TV is loud and clear. While we did miss some depth in the bass, the rest of the experience was quite good. At about 50% volume the TV can get quite loud and did not lose clarity.

**UI**

Stock Android TV is the name of the game here and that's what you get. Once the initial setup is done, the UI is butter smooth. Apart from one or two

hiccups here and there, we faced no problem with the UI during our tests.

**Remote control**

The remote control is the same one we saw on the 43-inch TV and one that we really liked. It has a teardrop design - extremely thin up-top and getting slightly thick at the bottom where you have the battery housing. This design gives the remote a good grip.

The buttons are simply laid out with the power and mute up top followed by the directional controls. It has dedicated hotkeys for Netflix, YouTube and Prime Video, which is nice.

**Build and design**

The TV is very well built. The bezels on three sides are extremely thin with the bottom bezel being slightly thick. The feet of the TV are strong and will hold it well in place when kept on a tabletop. The placement of the ports is aggravating. While we have two USB ports, antenna and a mini AV In on the side, the 3.5mm port, LAN port, three HDMI ports are at the back, facing down. This means that whether you place the TV on a tabletop or wall-mount it, it can get quite difficult to reach the HDMI ports.

**Bottom line**

Considering the 40K price of the TV, it's a little hard to recommend, especially when you consider the options on offer. We have the 55-inch Nokia TV with JBL speakers available at 42K, we have the Hisense 55A71F available at about 38K and many more options to consider. What the Realme TV has going for it is a good build and pretty good performance when you do get the option to control the picture settings.

—Sameer Mitha

**Display and picture quality**

The Realme SLED TV has a VA panel. It is a 4K panel with support for HDR 10 but it sadly does not support Dolby Vision. The TV has a peak brightness of about 300 nits and we have seen TVs like the Thomson OATH bring with it 500 nits of brightness for far better HDR performance. The TV does not have any dimming zones either.

**Performance**

When watching HDR content like Our Planet, which shows some vast deserts, the display looked slightly burnt. The content looked overexposed. Switch the sequence where Our Planet shows a starry sky, and we have a lush star-filled night. Switching over to the Fire TV Stick 4K, we changed the picture preset from Standard to Movie, and the overexposed sequence looked a lot better. Even though one can enjoy HDR

**SPECIFICATIONS**

PANEL SIZE: 55-INCH | TYPE: VA SLED | RESOLUTION: 3840 X 2160 | REFRESH RATE: 60HZ | HDR 10 SUPPORT: YES | DOLBY VISION SUPPORT: NO | WEIGHT (WITH STAND): 12.6 KGS | HDMI PORTS: 3, USB PORTS: 2 | BLUETOOTH, ETHERNET AND WI-FI: YES | SPEAKERS: 24W | BUILT-IN STORAGE: 16GB

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